



» TOURNAMENT REVIEW CHESS WORLD CUP

Big win: Champion Javokhir Sindarov defeated Wei Yi in the final, both securing places for the Candidates. MICHAL WALUSZA/FIDE

SINDAROV SUPREMACY

India's brightest stars falter as **Sindarov, Wei and Esipenko** win the three coveted tickets to the Candidates.

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The road to Resort Rio is rustic, shaded generously by trees and lined with charming, old-style houses. Along the way, you will also come across bars and restaurants where elderly foreigners, most of them from the UK, enjoy drinks and fabulous food at their leisure. This is Goa, after all. Last month, however, the resort in the North Goan village of Arpora was abuzz with more than just tourists. As the venue for the FIDE Chess World Cup, it hosted over 200

participants from around the world, all vying for the top three spots that would secure direct tickets to the Candidates, the qualifying event that determines the challenger for the World Championship.

That is the tradition in chess: the reigning champion gets the opportunity to defend the crown without having to play any qualifying games. **The challenger comes through the gruelling Candidates tournament, in which eight players take on each other in the double round-robin format.**

As Loek van Wely (the Dutch Grandmaster who has worked as a second with World